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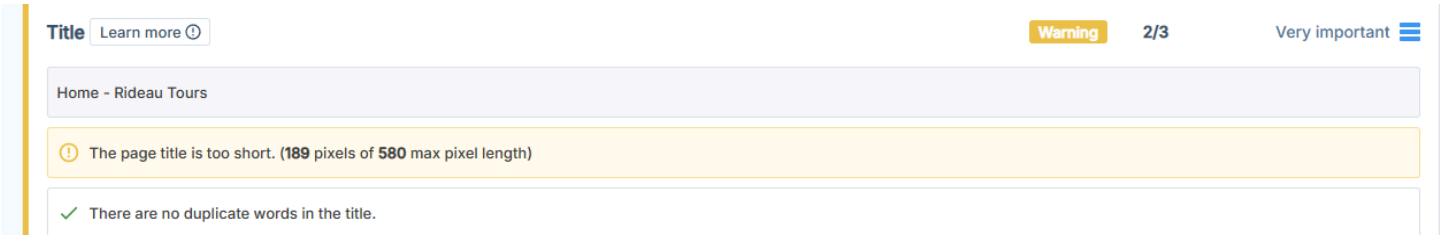
Search Engine Optimization

Major Project Part 2

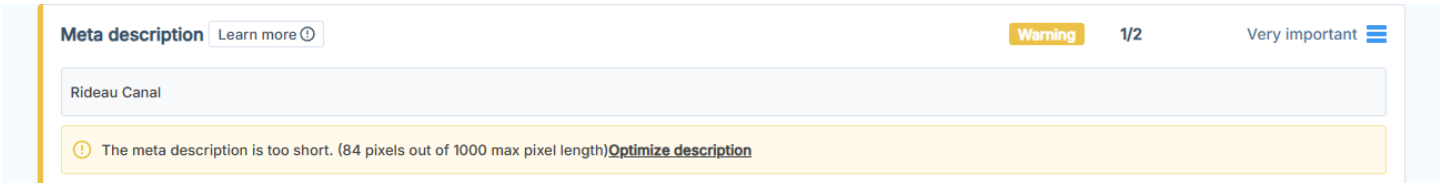
Saturday, March 7 2026

The site audit identified several technical and SEO issues that may affect the Rideau Tours website's performance in search results. Key issues include short title tags and meta descriptions, limited page content, missing alt text on some images, and a weak backlink profile. The audit also detected broken links and opportunities to improve internal linking and keyword optimization. While the website performs well in areas such as page speed and mobile responsiveness, addressing these issues could help improve search engine visibility, user experience, and overall website performance.

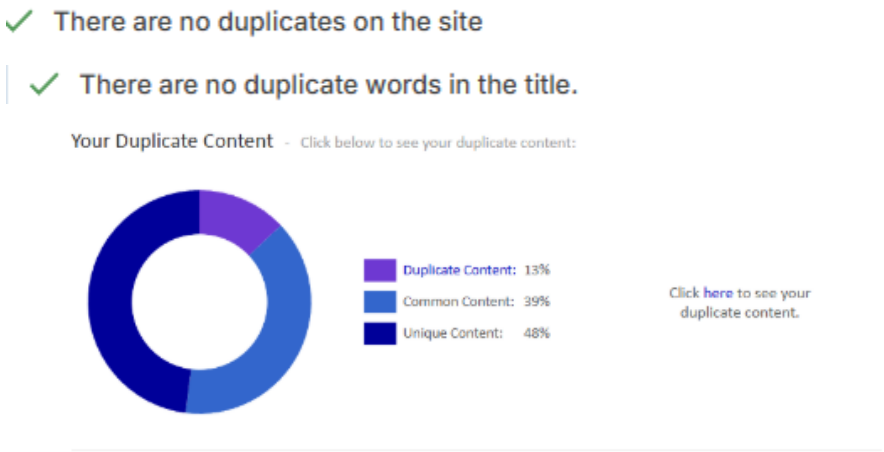
SEO on page factors & Technical SEO from SEObility



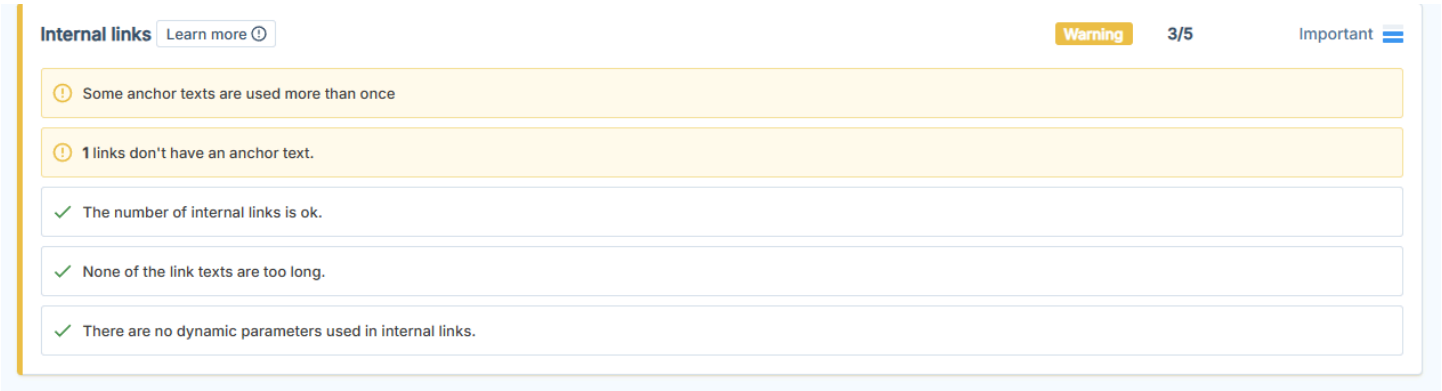
"Home – Rideau Tours," is too short and lacks descriptive keywords, which hurts ranking and click-through rates.



The audit found the homepage meta description is too short ("Rideau Canal") and lacks service details. Short meta descriptions hurt search engine results; they need to inform users before clicking.

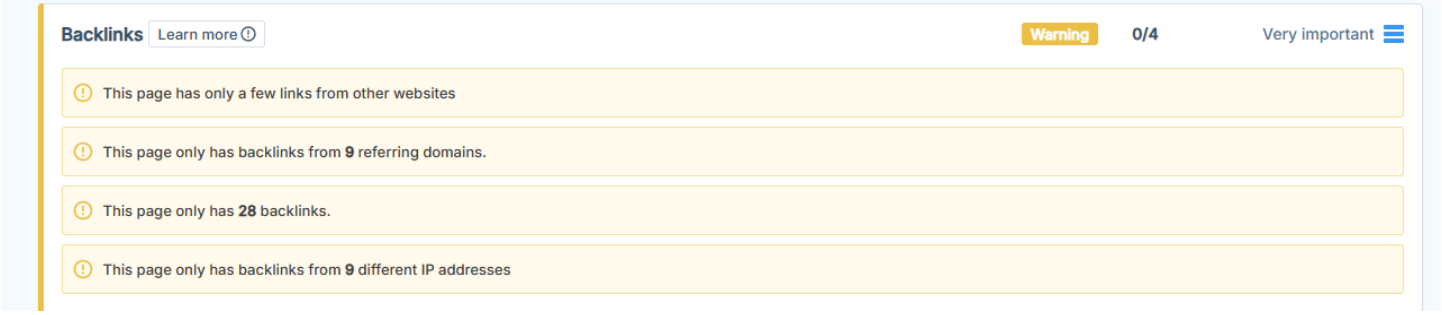


No duplicate pages were found, but **13% duplicate content** (likely from repeated elements like menus) was identified. Increase unique content to improve SEO and website quality.



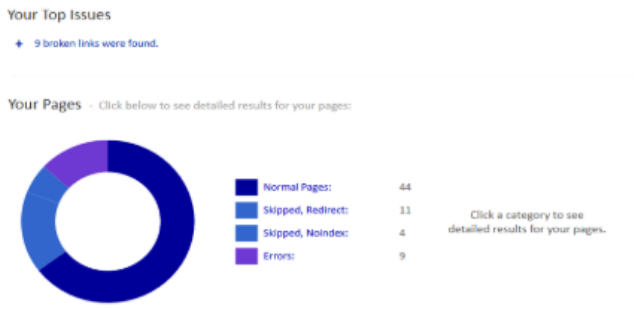
The SEObility audit of Rideau Tours' internal linking found the link count and anchor text length acceptable, supporting a clear site structure. However, the audit noted repeated and one missing anchor text. Optimizing anchor text is recommended to improve SEO and navigation.

SEObility confirms excellent mobile optimization, with seamless layout adjustment across all screen sizes (smartphones/tablets) via proper viewport configuration. This, along with Apple Touch icons for home screen addition, significantly improves usability and is vital for search engine ranking.

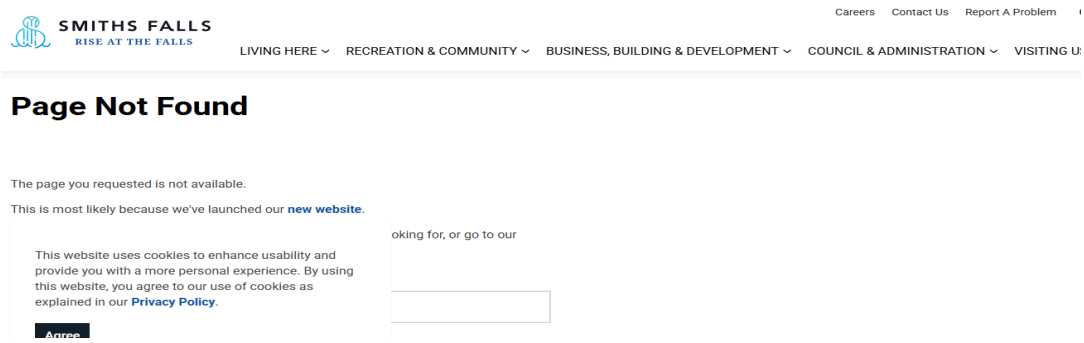


The **SEObility backlink analysis** revealed a **limited profile** for Rideau Tours, showing only **28 backlinks** from **9 referring domains/IPs**. This **"Warning – Very Important" issue** indicates **weak off-page SEO**, as the **low backlink count** reduces **domain authority** and **search visibility**, highlighting the need to **acquire more high-quality backlinks**.

Technical SEO

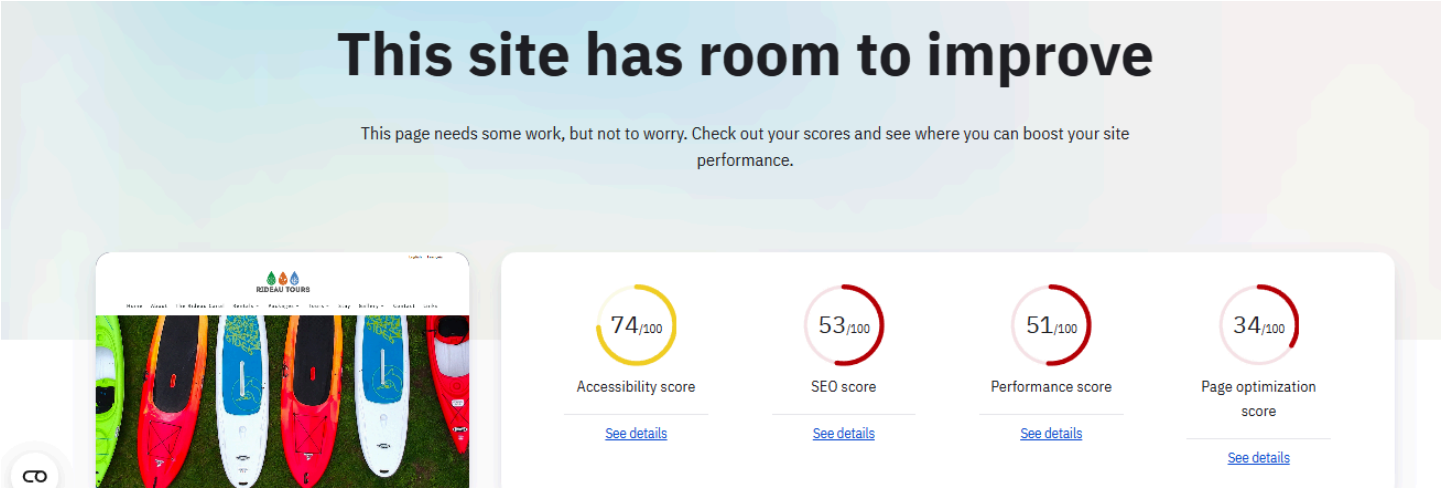


The SEObility audit identified **three broken links on the Rideau Tours website**, which negatively affects user experience and SEO by frustrating users and impeding search engine indexing.

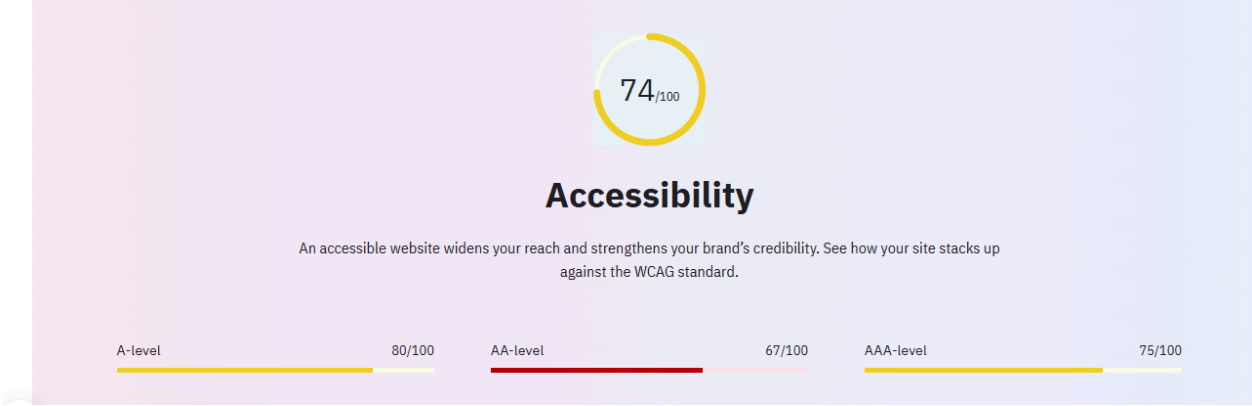


This is screenshot of 401 Error page I found on the website that has not been removed yet

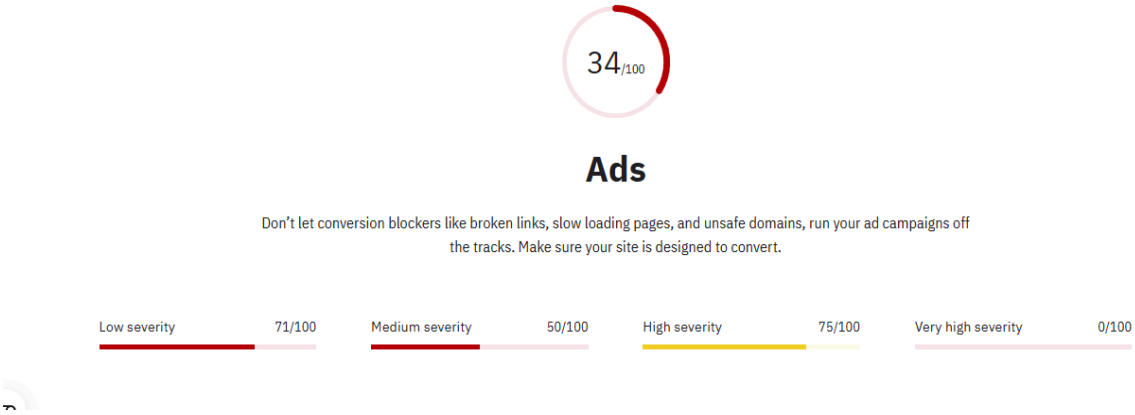
Siteimprove Analysis



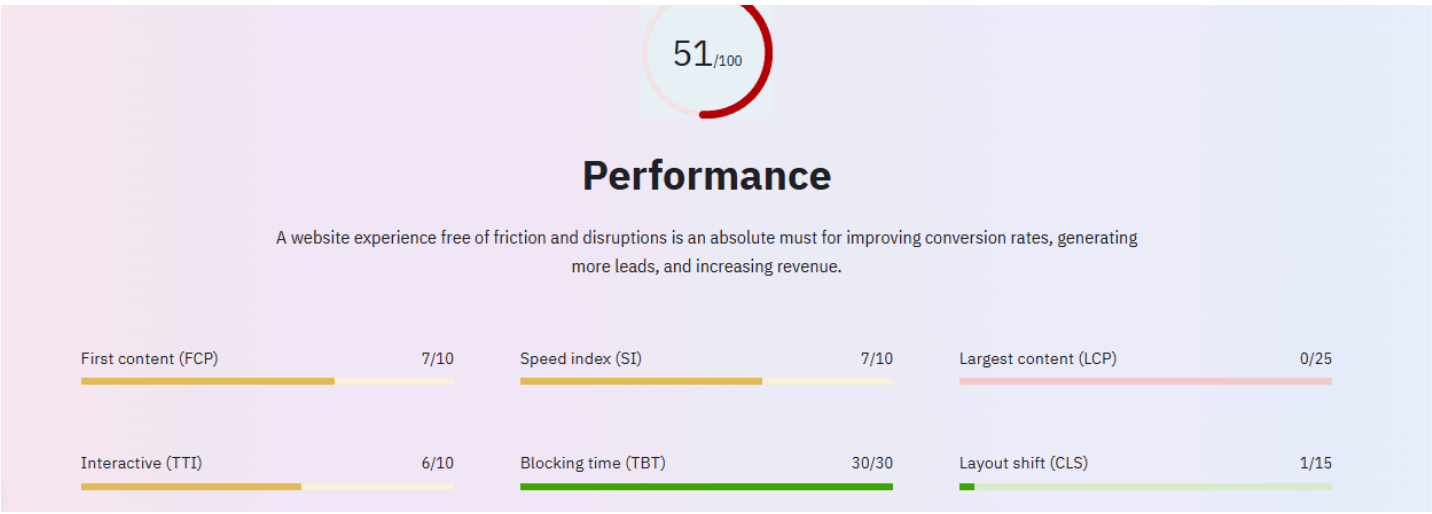
The Rideau Tours website's Siteimprove audit scores require significant improvement: accessibility (74/100), SEO (53/100), performance (51/100), and page optimization (34/100). Boosting SEO, performance, and page optimization is essential for better search visibility and user experience.



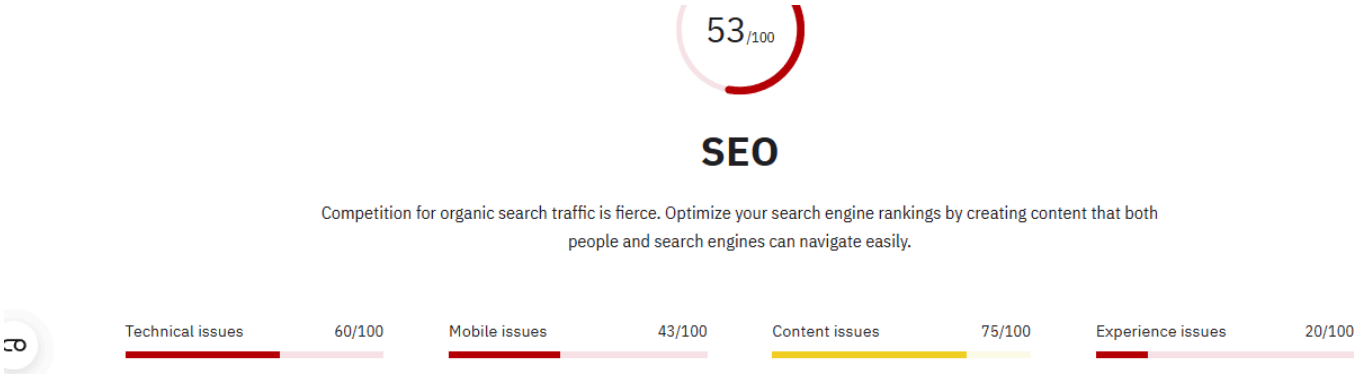
Siteimprove audit gave the **Rideau Tours website** an **accessibility score of 74/100**, indicating it meets **some standards** but needs **improvement** for **wider accessibility**.



A low **Siteimprove Ads optimization score** (**34/100**) signals **poor paid advertising performance** due to **conversion barriers** (**broken links**, **slow pages**, **technical issues**). This necessitates aligning **website performance**, **technical SEO**, and **user experience** with **digital advertising** to boost **campaign effectiveness** and **conversions**.

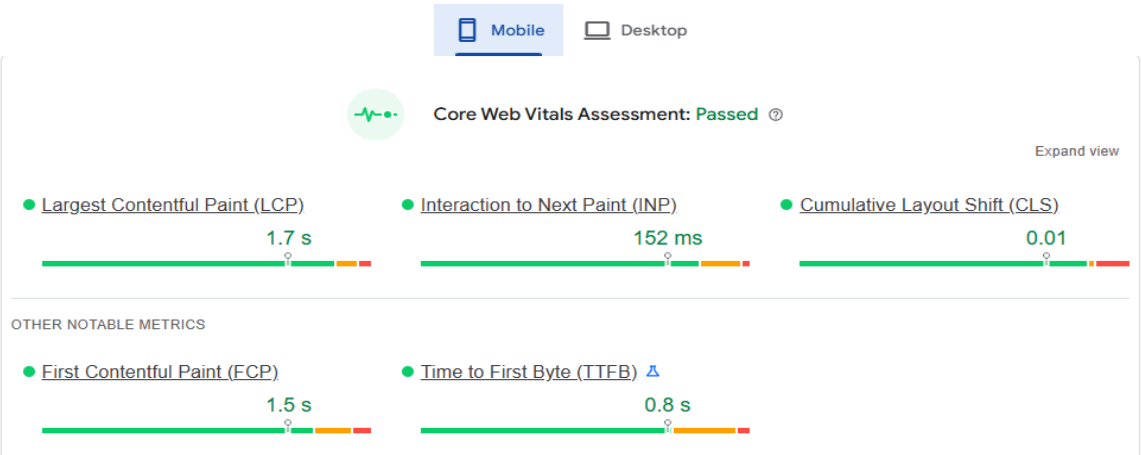


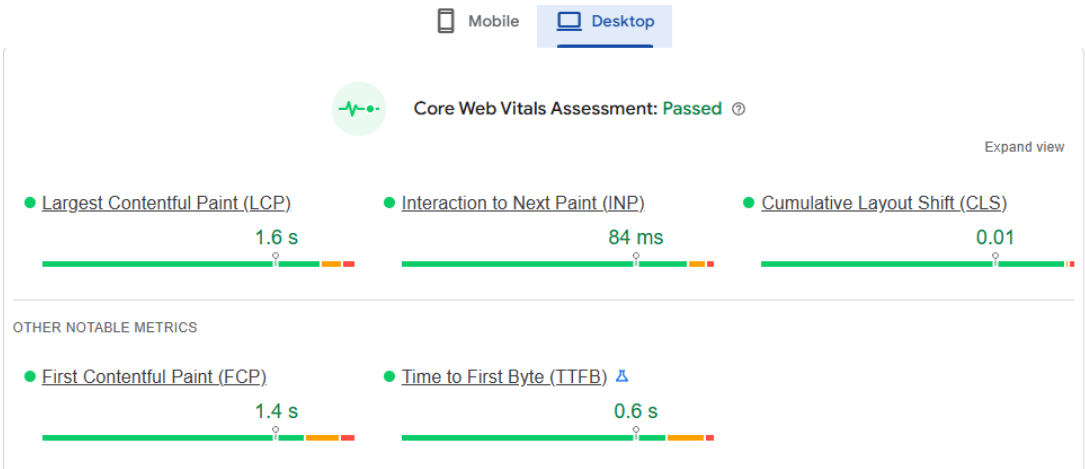
Rideau Tours website's **Siteimprove performance audit** resulted in a **low score of 51/100**, indicating **major speed and loading efficiency issues**. The **analysis of key metrics (FCP, SI, TTI, TBT, LCP, CLS)** highlighted **poor performance** in areas like **LCP and CLS**, which **negatively impact user experience** and **page loading**. Addressing these factors is **crucial for improving site speed, user engagement, conversion rates, and SEO**.



Siteimprove's SEO analysis of Rideau Tours resulted in a low overall score of **53/100**. Key issues were identified in **technical SEO (60/100)**, **mobile optimization (43/100)**, **content (75/100)**, and **user experience (20/100)**. Addressing these areas—especially technical issues, mobile usability, and content quality—is essential to improve search visibility, rankings, and user engagement.

Google Page Speed Insights





Rideau Tours' website excels in **Core Web Vitals**, **meeting all Google metrics** with **fast LCP** (1.6s desktop/1.7s mobile), **quick INP responsiveness** (84ms desktop/152ms mobile), and **excellent CLS** (0.01).

Reflection

A technical SEO audit (using **SEObility**, **Google PageSpeed Insights**, and **Siteimprove**) of Rideau Tours identified several issues: **short title tags/meta descriptions**, **low homepage content** (328 words), **technical flaws** (**missing/repeated anchor text**, **broken links**), and **limited backlinks**. However, the site is

fundamentally sound, passing **Core Web Vitals**, and featuring **good page speed** and **mobile configuration**. Improvement is needed in **content**, **metadata**, and **link optimization**.

Content Marketing and SEO (Unit 2)

Content marketing is an important part of improving a website's visibility on search engines. Currently, the Rideau Tours website has **limited written content**, especially on the homepage.

Creating more useful and informative content can help the website rank for more search terms and attract more visitors.

For example, the business could publish content such as:

- Guides about **activities on the Rideau Canal**
- Articles about **kayaking or paddle boarding in Ottawa**
- Travel tips for **tourists visiting Ottawa**
- Seasonal content related to **summer outdoor activities**

Adding more valuable content can help improve the website's **search rankings, user engagement, and overall authority**.

Keyword Research (Unit 3)

Keyword research was conducted using **WordStream** to identify search terms related to Rideau Tours and its services.

Examples of **short-tail keywords** include: Rideau Canal tours ,Ottawa kayak rental , Paddle board Ottawa Rideau Canal activities
, Ottawa boat tours

Examples of **long-tail keywords** include:Kayak rentals near Rideau Canal Ottawa , Paddle boarding tours in Ottawa , Things to do on Rideau Canal in summer , Guided kayak tours Ottawa , Best outdoor activities in Ottawa

Keyword research for Rideau Tours used WordStream to identify search terms.

Short-tail keywords: Rideau Canal tours, Ottawa kayak rental, Paddle board Ottawa, Rideau Canal activities, Ottawa boat tours.**Long-tail keywords:** Kayak rentals near Rideau Canal Ottawa, Paddle boarding tours in Ottawa, Things to do on Rideau Canal in summer, Guided kayak tours Ottawa, Best outdoor activities in Ottawa.

Local SEO

Local SEO is especially important for businesses that rely on local customers or tourists. During the analysis, it appears that **Rideau Tours does not currently have a Google Business Profile**, which is an important tool for improving local search visibility.

Creating and optimizing a Google Business Profile could help the business appear in **Google Maps and local search results**.

Other local SEO strategies could include:

- Getting **backlinks from local tourism websites**
- Being listed in **Ottawa business directories**
- Partnering with **local tourism organizations**
- Encouraging **Google reviews**

A technical SEO audit found the Rideau Tours website needs improvements in content, metadata, and link optimization (e.g., short title tags, low homepage word count, missing/repeated anchor text, broken links, limited backlinks). The site passes Core Web Vitals and has good page speed.

Key Recommendations:

- **Content:** Create guides and articles (kayaking, travel tips) to boost SEO and engagement.
- **Keywords:** Target short-tail (e.g., Rideau Canal tours) and long-tail terms (e.g., Kayak rentals near Rideau Canal Ottawa).
- **Local SEO:** Establish a Google Business Profile, acquire local backlinks, and encourage Google reviews.

SEO Strategy

Critical Issues

- Based on the audit results, several key issues should be prioritized. These include **short title tags and meta descriptions, low content on the homepage, missing alt text on images, broken links, and a limited backlink profile**. Addressing these problems can help improve both search engine rankings and user experience.
- **Actionable Recommendations**

On-Page SEO

- To improve on-page SEO, the website should optimize its **title tags, meta descriptions, and heading structure**. Adding more content to the homepage and including relevant keywords can also help search engines better understand the page.
- It is also important to add **alt text to images** and ensure that headings such as **H1 and H2 tags** are properly used.

Technical SEO

- Technical improvements should focus on **fixing broken links, improving internal linking structure, and optimizing page elements**. These changes can make it easier for search engines to crawl and index the website.

Local SEO

- To improve local visibility, Rideau Tours should create a **Google Business Profile** and include key information such as location, contact details, photos, and business hours. Encouraging customers to leave reviews and building backlinks from local tourism websites can also strengthen local SEO.

Keyword Optimization

- The keywords identified during the research phase should be integrated throughout the website, including **page titles, meta descriptions, headings, and content**. Using a mix of **short-tail and long-tail keywords** can help the website attract different types of search traffic.

Citations

Google. (n.d.). *PageSpeed Insights*. https://pagespeed.web.dev/

SEObility. (n.d.). *SEO Checker & Website Audit Tool*. https://www.seobility.net/

Siteimprove. (n.d.). *Website Optimization and SEO Tools*. https://www.siteimprove.com/

WordStream. (n.d.). *Free Keyword Tool*. https://www.wordstream.com/keywords